

Room Status Guide

How rooms move from Dirty to Inspected — who does what, and why

For hotel management, housekeeping and front office · October 2026

In one page

Hestia follows the standard hotel housekeeping flow. Every room is always in one clear state, each person only sees the changes that are theirs to make, and the same rules are checked again on the server, so they cannot be bypassed.

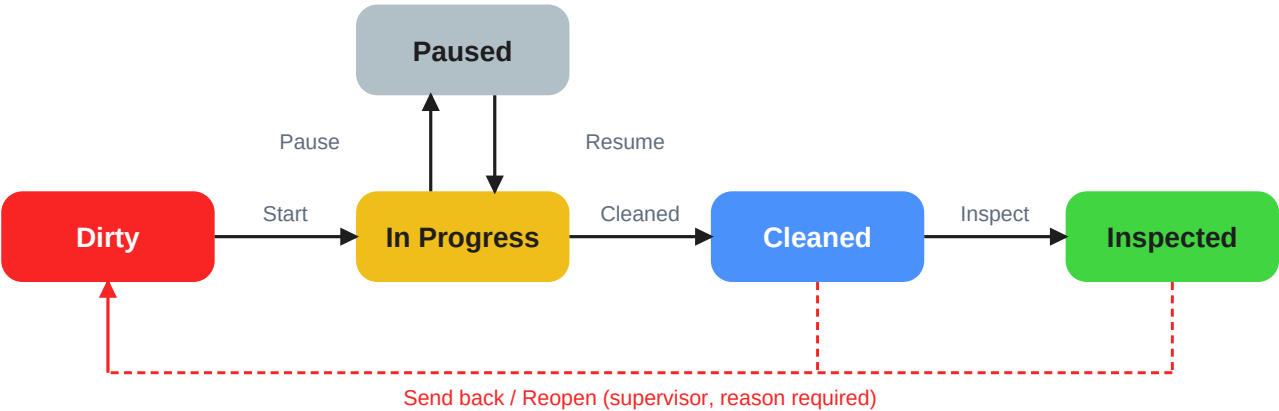
- **Room attendants** work their **own** rooms step by step: start, pause, resume, cleaned — and report Do Not Disturb, Refuse Service or Return Later. They cannot skip a step.
- **Managers and supervisors** can do everything: assign rooms, take any step, and switch a room to **any state in any order** — for example straight from Dirty to Inspected. Sending a cleaned room back asks for a reason.
- **Promise time** is set and removed by managers and supervisors only.
- **Front office** sees every room's status (Inspected = ready to check in) and can mark a room priority.
- Everything important is recorded in the room's history, and the right people are notified.

Good to know Nothing in day-to-day use needs to be configured. The behaviour below is the default for every hotel; a few options can be adjusted per hotel (see "Hotel settings").

Before you start Please make sure every device has the latest version of the Hestia app before you start.

1. The journey of a room

Every room is always in exactly one state. The diagram shows the normal path an attendant follows, the pause loop, the supervisor's "send back", and the guest situations that interrupt service. Cleaned and Inspected are each confirmed with a short checklist. Managers and supervisors are not limited to this path: they can move a room to any state.



Guest situations (while a room still needs service; from In Progress the room returns to Dirty):

Do Not Disturb

Refuse Service

Return Later

When the situation ends (sign removed, guest wants service, time to go back) the room is Dirty again, ready to start.

State	What it means
● Dirty	The room needs cleaning. This is where every room starts the day.
● In Progress	The room is being cleaned now. The cleaning timer is running.
● Paused	Cleaning stopped for a moment (break, fetching supplies). The timer is stopped.
● Cleaned	Cleaning finished and the clean checklist completed. Waiting for inspection.
● Inspected	Checked by a supervisor with the inspection checklist. Ready for the guest.
● Do Not Disturb	A DND sign is on the door. It is re-checked on a schedule.
● Refuse Service	The guest declined service today, with a reason.
● Return Later	The guest asked for service at a later time. The attendant is reminded at that time.

2. Who does what

Role	Typical job titles	Can do
Room Attendant	Room attendant	The cleaning steps, in order, on rooms assigned to them. One room in progress at a time.
Supervisor	Supervisor, senior supervisor, coordinator	Everything: assign / reassign / unassign, any step on any room, switch a room to any state in any order, inspect, send back, set and remove promise times, priority, flag.
Manager	Executive housekeeper, HK manager, assistant manager, hotel management	Everything a supervisor can do.
Front Office	Front office agents, senior front office	Sees all statuses. Marks a room priority. No housekeeping status changes, no promise times.
Everyone else	Porters, laundry, public area, concierge, in-room dining, technical	Sees rooms they have access to. Can raise a flag where their role allows. No status changes.

Note The app decides what to show from the person's job title, which the hotel already sets up. No extra setup is needed.

3. For room attendants

Open the room from your Rooms list, or tap its status on the card. The **Change Status** menu only shows the steps you can take right now. If an option is not there, it is not your step yet.

When the room is...	You will see	You will not see
● Dirty	In Progress (start), Do Not Disturb, Refuse Service, Return Later	Cleaned, Inspected, Pause
● In Progress	Pause, Cleaned (opens the checklist), Return Later, Refuse Service. Undo start for the first 2 minutes.	Inspected, Do Not Disturb
● Paused	Resume, Return Later	Cleaned — resume first, so your time is counted correctly
● Do Not Disturb	Still DND (record another check), Sign removed	Everything else
● Refuse Service	Service back on (the guest changed their mind)	Everything else
● Return Later	In Progress (start when you are back), change the time, Clear return	Everything else
● Cleaned / ● Inspected	Nothing — the room is finished for you	Everything

Cleaning a room, step by step

1. Find the room in your list (only your assigned rooms are shown). It is **Dirty**.
2. Tap the status, choose **In Progress**. The timer starts. Tapped by mistake? Choose **Undo start** within 2 minutes — the room goes back to Dirty and no time is recorded.
3. Need to step away? Choose **Pause**; the timer stops. Choose **Resume** when you are back.
4. When finished, choose **Cleaned**. Complete the clean checklist, add photos or a note if needed, and slide to confirm.
5. The room is now **Cleaned** and your supervisor is notified. Your part is done.

Rules that help you

- **One room at a time.** You cannot start a second room while one is in progress. Pause or finish the first one.
- **Only your rooms.** You can only change rooms assigned to you.
- **Guest situations.** Use Do Not Disturb when the sign is up, Refuse Service when the guest declines (choose a reason), and Return Later when the guest asks you to come back (choose the time). If you were cleaning, the room returns to Dirty.

4. For managers and supervisors

Changing a room's status

Tap a room's status: the menu shows **every state** the room can move to. You are not limited to the attendant's order — you can, for example, set a room straight from Dirty to Inspected, take an Inspected room back to In Progress, or mark a paused room Cleaned.

- **In Progress** needs an attendant assigned to the room first (it is their cleaning time that is measured).
- **Back to Dirty**: an in-progress or paused room goes straight back and its cleaning time is cleared. A **Cleaned** room is **sent back**, an **Inspected** room is **reopened** — both ask for a reason (Failed inspection, Guest complaint, Missed item), and the attendant is told why.
- **Guest situations** (Do Not Disturb, Refuse Service, Return Later) can be set while a room still needs service. A Cleaned or Inspected room has nothing left to service, so they are not offered there. You can also clear them: Sign removed, Service back on, Clear return.

Assigning rooms

- Assign from the room card's **Assign** button, from a room's detail page, or in bulk from **Staff** → **See rooms** → **Action** (Assign, Reassign, Unassign).
- The attendant is notified the moment a room is assigned to them.
- Reassigning a room that is being cleaned **pauses it** and hands it to the new attendant, who resumes it. The first attendant is told, and the time they spent is recorded in the room's history.

Inspecting

1. Open a room's status and choose **Inspected**.
2. Go through the inspection checklist and slide to confirm. The room is **Inspected** — ready for the guest.
3. If it fails, choose **Send back to Dirty** on the checklist. The reason "Failed inspection" is recorded and the attendant is notified with that reason.

Promise time

- Only managers and supervisors can **set** or **remove** a promise time — from the status menu ("Set Promise Time") or on the room's page (Change time, Remove).
- The attendant is notified and sees it on the room card. It ends automatically when the room is Cleaned or Inspected.

5. For front office

- **Status at a glance:** Inspected means the room is ready to check in. Cleaned means it is waiting for inspection.
- **Promise time:** you can see a room's promise time. To promise a guest an early room, ask a housekeeping manager or supervisor to set it.
- **Priority:** mark a room priority when it is needed urgently. Housekeeping sees it immediately.
- Front office does not change housekeeping status — that keeps one clear owner for each step.

6. What happens automatically

When	What happens
A room is started	The supervisor who assigned it is told "Cleaning started" — after 2 minutes, so a mistaken tap that was undone never sends a notice.
A room is cleaned	The supervisor who assigned it is notified.
A room is sent back or reopened	The attendant is notified, with the reason.
A promise time is set or removed	The attendant is notified.
A Do Not Disturb re-check is due	The attendant is reminded (or the supervisors, if nobody is assigned).
DND past the cut-off	Supervisors get a welfare-check alert.
Return Later time arrives	The attendant is reminded; if 30 minutes pass without starting, supervisors are told.
A shift ends	Unfinished rooms that nobody is cleaning go back to the unassigned pool for the next shift, and the supervisor is told how many. Rooms being cleaned stay with their attendant.
A new day starts	Refusals and return-laters from yesterday end. Rooms a guest slept in that were Cleaned or Inspected go back to Dirty for today's service.

7. Records and accountability

- Each room's **History** tab shows what happened and who did it — including send-backs and reopenings with their reason, undone starts, and handovers between attendants.
- Cleaning time is measured by the system from the moment a room is started, excluding pauses. It drives credits, the Staff screen and the Activity reports.
- Every rule is checked on the server as well as in the app, so the flow is followed the same way on every phone.
- If two people change the same room at the same moment, one change is applied and the other person sees "...is not available while the room is... Refresh to see its current state." Nothing is overwritten silently.
- A tap repeated on a poor connection is applied only once.

8. Hotel settings

These are set per hotel. The defaults below are active now; ask us to change any of them.

Setting	Default	What it does
Undo start window	2 minutes	How long an attendant can undo a mistaken start.
Shift end	Return to pool	Unfinished rooms go back to the unassigned pool at the end of a shift. Alternative: keep them assigned.
New-day reset	On	Rooms a guest slept in go back to Dirty each morning. Can be turned off.
Status rules	On	The flow described in this guide. Can be paused for a hotel during a transition.

9. Questions we expect

An option I used to have is missing.

The menu only shows what you can do for the room's current state. Attendants follow the steps in order: Cleaned appears once the room is In Progress. Managers and supervisors see every state.

I started the wrong room.

Choose Undo start within 2 minutes. After that, Pause it and start the right one — or ask a supervisor to set it back to Dirty.

It says another room is still in progress.

Attendants work one room at a time. Pause or finish the room it names, then start the next.

An attendant's phone died mid-clean.

A supervisor can finish the steps for the room directly, or reassign it — it will be handed over paused, with the time so far kept.

A cleaned room had an issue after inspection.

A supervisor chooses Reopen, picks the reason, and the attendant is told.

I can't set a promise time.

Promise times are set by housekeeping managers and supervisors only.

Why did my unfinished rooms disappear after my shift?

They went back to the pool so the next shift can be assigned them. Your supervisor was notified.